



StudySyncTV

Scene Description

Four students sit around a table in a library. The students' books, digital devices, and notebooks are out on the table. While they talk, other students work quietly in the background.

Transcript

00:00 (INTRODUCTION PLAYS)

00:14 ELLIE: This scene is so painful.

00:16 MILES: This whole play is so painful.

00:18 TROY: Reading this play is like watching a trainwreck in slow motion.

00:19 I thought it was awesome!

00:22 YASMEEN: Okay - by painful, do you mean the vocab?

00:23 Because I had to stop and look stuff up.

00:25 Like, "Suppliants?"

00:27 ELLIE: Not the vocab, the story.

00:29 You know what's gonna happen but you're powerless to change it.

00:31 MILES: Well apparently, in ancient Greece, people came back year after year to watch this play.

00:34 Even though they knew what the outcome was.

00:36 ELLIE: Which is what the assignment is about, right?

00:37 Does anyone have it?

00:39 YASMEEN: I do. Right here.

00:40 "When the reader knows more about a character's problem than the character does,

00:44 it is called 'dramatic irony.'

00:46 As a reader, describe the effect of knowing what Oedipus refuses to believe--"

00:50 TROY: The effect is that it's painful. Next!

00:52 YASMEEN: Okay, it's not that simple. Why is it painful?

00:55 MILES: Well, we feel sorry for the guy, for one.

00:57 I mean, Oedipus had no idea about all awful things he did.

01:00 TROY: To recap...?

01:02 ELLIE: 1) killed his father.

01:03 2) married his mother and had her babies-

01:07 YASMEEN: 3) unwittingly brought plague of infertility onto his kingdom by doing 1 & 2.

01:11 MILES: As King, you would think that you would try to find what's wrong with the city, right?

01:14 But really what he didn't know was that it was him that was wrong.

01:17 TROY: That's an example of dramatic irony, right?

01:19 MILES: Exactly!

01:20 ELLIE: But it wasn't Oedipus's fault! He didn't know he was adopted!

01:23 TROY: That's what I'm saying. It's his parents' fault.

01:25 Look if they wanted to make sure their little baby boy

01:27 wasn't going to grow and kill his father, they should have made sure the baby was actually dead.

01:32 YASMEEN: You want a job done right, do it yourself.

01:34 TROY: Exactly. Of course the maid was gonna have second thoughts at the end.

01:37 I coulda told you that.

01:39 ELLIE: And the irony is that in trying to avoid the prophecy, Oedipus's parents make it come true.

01:44 MILES: Obviously if they would've raised the kid themselves, he would have known who his dad was!

01:47 ELLIE: And Jocasta who her son was.

01:49 TROY: Whoops?

01:50 YASMEEN: On the other hand, is Oedipus completely innocent though?

01:52 He might not know what he did, but he's still pretty rude to that Teiresias guy.

01:57 TROY: Yeah! He accuses Teiresias --

01:59 who is not only old, but blind -- he accuses him of planning Laius's murder.

02:04 He says: "methinks thou art he, Who planned the crime, aye, and performed it too."

02:10 ELLIE: Can you blame him, though?

02:12 He's trying to lift the plague off his city and the guy won't give him anything.

02:16 MILES: Besides, what good is knowing the truth?

02:18 Teiresias says, "Alas, alas, what misery to be wise/When wisdom profits nothing!"

02:24 ELLIE: True. It's not like Oedipus can go back in time

02:26 and not kill his father and marry his mother.

02:29 YASMEEN: Yeah but in the end my sympathies lie with Teiresias.

02:32 I wouldn't want to be the one to tell this guy the deal.

02:34 TROY: No kidding. Oedipus has got quite a temper.

02:37 I mean, he once killed a guy over a right-of-way dispute.

02:40 Pretty extreme to me.

02:42 ELLIE: But that was a long time ago.

02:43 I mean, now he's trying to take care of his people.

02:45 YASMEEN: I agree that knowing what Oedipus doesn't know kind of makes me feel sorry for him,

02 : 48 at least at the beginning....

02 : 50 TROY: But my pity doesn't last long because he's acting like such a piece of work.

02 : 52 ELLIE: And that's the second part of the prompt: "What does his reaction tell you about Oedipus?"

02 : 56 What can you conclude about him from his conversation with Teiresias?"

03 : 00 TROY: I just said; he's a piece of work.

03 : 02 ELLIE: Nice, Troy.

03 : 04 MILES: Troy's got a point.

03 : 05 You can see Teiresias going through a similar process.

03 : 06 He doesn't want to tell Oedipus the truth at first because he feels sorry for the guy.

03 : 10 TROY: Or because he's afraid of him.

03 : 12 MILES: But, the more Oedipus abuses him, Teiresias says,

03 : 14 "Okay, you want the truth? Boom. Try this on for size."

03 : 17 YASMEEN: But it doesn't even occur to Oedipus

03 : 18 that the prophet is actually telling the truth. Right?

03 : 21 He's too preoccupied with this idea that this guy, Teiresias is just being stubborn.

03 : 25 What does he say?

03 : 27 "Vile slanderer, thou blurtest forth these taunts."

03 : 30 TROY: Yeah, he starts accusing the old guy of being a bad prophet.

03 : 34 "Who was thy teacher?" he says.

03 : 36 Like he must be doing it wrong.

03 : 38 ELLIE: Which pushes Teiresias over the edge, right?

03 : 40 He says, "thou, goading me against my will to speak" -

03 : 44 he's like, "Look, buddy, I didn't want to do this but...."

03 : 48 TROY: "...you've dragged it outta me by because you are asking like such a piece of work."

03 : 52 MILES: "Thou art the murderer of the man/Whose murderer thou pursuest." More irony!

03 : 55 YASMEEN: And Oedipus still doesn't believe him-him just assumes Teiresias is trying to get a rise out of him.

04 : 00 ELLIE: I'm not sure I'd believe him either!

04 : 02 I mean, that's a pretty big pill Teiresias is asking Oedipus to swallow.

04 : 05 TROY: But it's not just that Oedipus is skeptical of Teiresias.

04 : 09 He gets super-defensive. Starts calling him names!

04 : 12 He gets all self-righteous -"you think you're a prophet?

04 : 16 I'm the prophet, I solved the Sphinx's riddle"-

04 : 19 YASMEEN: And then he gets paranoid, accusing Teiresias of joining his friend in trying take over the kingdom.

04 : 24 TROY: He's got way too much pride.

04 : 26 ELLIE: But he's about to get punished for it!

04 : 28 Oedipus going to eventually recognize the truth and be forced to exile himself.

04 : 31 TROY: That's true. This family is about to get truth-bombed.

04 : 34 Listen here: "the dogging curse of mother and sire/One day shall drive thee,
04 : 39 like a two-edged sword/Beyond our borders,
04 : 42 and the eyes that now/See clear shall henceforward endless night."
04 : 46 ELLIE: Oh. Right. He gouges his eyes out, too.
04 : 48 MILES: On that point-the whole blindness thing.
04 : 50 Guess the point that I am going to bring up here guys.
04 : 52 YASMEEN: Could it possibly be irony?
04 : 54 MILES: It is!
04 : 55 TROY: Wait-I'm not seeing it.
04 : 57 YASMEEN: Not seeing it? Troy, you're killing me.
05 : 00 MILES: The irony is that Oedipus is mocking Teiresias for being blind
05 : 02 when we know that Oedipus is gonna end up blind in the end.
05 : 05 TROY: Oohh.
05 : 07 ELLIE: Clearly, Oedipus metaphorically blind.
05 : 09 The prophet is showing him the truth, and he is just not seeing it.
05 : 12 TROY: Because he has too much pride to recognize the truth.
05 : 14 ELLIE: I don't know. I keep coming back to this kind of not being his fault.
05 : 17 TROY: What? It's all his fault!
05 : 19 If he weren't so arrogant.
05 : 21 YASMEEN: Hubris, isn't that what this is all about?
05 : 24 TROY: Hubris? Who's Hubris? He is not in this play.
05 : 26 ELLIE: Hubris is not a person.
05 : 28 It's an ancient Greek version of arrogance.
05 : 31 MILES: It's when people think too highly of themselves that rules don't apply to them.
05 : 35 That is the meaning of the word Hubris.
05 : 37 YASMEEN: Yeah, the gods aren't so into that... attitude.
05 : 39 MILES: Okay, speaking of the gods, Teiresias says here, "thy weird is not to fall by me."
05 : 45 And here "weird" means "fate." So he's saying,
05 : 48 "I'm not the one you need to worry about." Right?
05 : 50 He also says here, "I leave to Apollo what concerns the god."
05 : 53 ELLIE: Teiresias is just the messenger.
05 : 55 Oedipus and his mom disobeyed the wrong god.
05 : 57 MILES: Yeah. And I wouldn't want to be in their shoes.
05 : 59 Right? Disobeying a god?
06 : 00 YASMEEN: Yeah. So maybe the message is:
06 : 02 Don't let the gods think that you think you're better than them.
06 : 04 TROY: Yeah. Good life-lesson for your average Greek theatergoer,
06 : 07 but it's obviously not something I need to worry about... ?

